

Travel & Reimbursement Policy 2026

Purpose & Principles

NavGurukul's travel and reimbursement policy is designed to ensure safety, dignity, and comfort for all team members — while maintaining frugality and responsible use of organisational resources.

Our aim is to prevent out-of-pocket burden on team members while also using resources wisely. Reimbursements are structured not by seniority, but by compensation bands, acknowledging that:

No team member should need to compromise on safety.

Some roles require extensive external-facing travel.

Cost optimisation must be fair, transparent, and predictable.

We encourage everyone to travel mindfully, choosing sustainable and cost-efficient options wherever possible.

Travel Reimbursement

2.1 Determining Mode of Travel

A. Distances Under 1,200 km

Default mode: Train or bus.

Flights may be considered if:

The fastest train route exceeds 24 hours, OR

The travel is urgent and approved by the manager, OR

The team member is above 50 years of age or has a medical requirement (with doctor's note).

B. Distances Above 1,200 km

Flights are permitted as the default mode of travel.

Standard cap: ₹5,000

If the flight cost exceeds ₹6,000, team members will be encouraged to explore multi-route options (e.g., train to a major hub or cheaper connecting flights).

If direct, feasible train options offer comfort without excessive time loss, teams are nudged to explore them as a frugal alternative.

The final mode of travel should balance cost, efficiency, and well-being, and must be approved by the People & Culture Team.

C. North-East India & Islands

For team members residing in NE states or Indian islands — Flight cap: ₹7,500

D. Time vs. Cost Principle

Where train or bus travel results in significant productive time loss, a flight may be approved even if the cost is slightly higher (*example: ₹3,000 train vs. ₹5,000 flight*).

Where travel time exceeds 1 to 1.5 full working day each way, a flight may be approved even within the 1,200 km threshold. Approvers should consider the total effective cost (ticket cost + daily rate × extra travel days) when evaluating options. There's no fixed

formula and the final decision would be taken by People & Culture by following this Principle.

2.2 Travel Cost Limits

Trains

Class	Cap	Notes
3AC	₹2,500	Default
2AC	Allowed	Only if 3AC unavailable & travel is 18–24 hrs

Buses

Type	Cap
Sleeper / Volvo	₹1,500

Personal Vehicle

Vehicle Type	Rate
2-wheeler	₹3 per km
4-wheeler	₹8 per km

Local Cabs

Purpose	Cap
Standard commute during work travel	₹500 per trip

Note: There should be no expectation of full-journey cab travel beyond ₹500 per trip, unless travel is during late hours, the route involves an unsafe locality, or public transport is unavailable. All team members are encouraged to use metro, airport buses, or other reliable public transport.

Accommodation

Accommodation allowances are aligned with compensation bands to ensure fairness and prevent unnecessary approvals.

Compensation Band (CTC / Month)	Per Night Cap	Suggested Options
Band 1: Up to ₹50,000	₹1,200	Verified youth hostels, dorms, guesthouses
Band 2: ₹50,000 – ₹1,00,000	₹2,000	Budget hotels, Airbnbs
Band 3: ₹1,00,000 and above	₹3,000 – ₹3,500	Verified 3-star hotels / business stays

General Guidelines

If an NG campus or flat exists in the city and has vacancy, staying there is strongly encouraged.

Safety and hygiene are non-negotiable across all bands.

NG will maintain a curated list of recommended stays to make booking easier and consistent.

Month-Long Stays

Cap: ₹8,000 per month, if NG accommodation is unavailable.

Food

Category	Limit
Non-campus travel (per day)	₹600 (₹200 per meal)
Networking meals — external stakeholders only	Up to ₹750
Meat & intoxicants	Not reimbursable
Travel to NG campus	Meals on campus expected

Cancellation Policy

Cancellations are unavoidable at times. The framework below determines how non-recoverable costs are shared.

A. Employee-Initiated Cancellation (Emergency)

If a team member needs to cancel due to a personal emergency (*medical, family bereavement, or acute personal crisis*), non-recoverable costs are split 50 / 50.

Employee bears 50% of the net non-recoverable cost.

Organisation bears 50% of the net non-recoverable cost.

"Non-recoverable cost" = actual amount lost after any refund or credit received.

Example: A ₹8,000 flight is cancelled and ₹2,000 is refunded. The employee bears ₹3,000 and the organisation bears ₹3,000.

B. Organisation-Initiated Cancellation

100% of the non-recoverable cost is borne by NavGurukul. There is no financial liability on the employee.

C. Force Majeure

Natural disasters, civil unrest, public health emergencies, etc. → 100% borne by the organisation. No deduction from the employee.

Note: All cancellations must be communicated promptly. The reason must be documented in the reimbursement notes, and the relevant approver must be informed.

Travel on Non-Working Days

Travel days are generally treated as working days when travel is for official purposes.

A. Meetups and Community Events

Travel for NavGurukul meetups or community events — which are known in advance and part of org culture — does not qualify for compensatory leave (comp-off), regardless of whether travel falls on a weekend or a scheduled day off.

B. Urgent, Org-Initiated Travel

If a team member is required by the organisation to travel on a scheduled day off (e.g., asked to travel on a Sunday for an urgent Monday engagement), they may be eligible for a comp-off with manager and PnC approval.

Key criteria:

The travel was org-initiated (not voluntary).

It was not reasonably foreseeable in advance.

Manager approval is obtained before or immediately after the travel.

All comp-off requests under this clause must be recorded in the HR system within 5 working days of the travel date.

Additional Guidelines

Travel for joining or vacating campus at start or end of tenure is reimbursed (excluding relocation costs or extra baggage charges).

Vipassana reimbursement is allowed only for Associates, interns, and FTEs earning less than ₹25,000/month — by train or bus, booked at least 15 days in advance.

Travel for student-specific work (hospital visits, campus events, etc.) is billed to Campus Operations.

Minimise flights where feasible; choose sustainable modes of travel.

Approvals

Within Policy

Who	Approves What
Manager	Travel need
People & Culture Team	Travel route and costs
PM / Ops Manager / Ops Lead	Campus operations travel

Beyond Policy

Permitted only under exceptional, well-documented circumstances. Reason must be recorded in reimbursement notes and supported by an approval email.

Documentation Requirements

Requirement	Detail
Bills required for	All expenses of ₹500 or more
UPI proof required for	Expenses without bills under ₹500
Vouchers without proof	Allowed only up to ₹200
Approver & claimant	Must always be different people
Exceptions	Reason in reimbursement notes + approval email

Last updated: June 2026 · For queries, contact the People & Culture Team

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